

PPO Parameters Reference (Current Implementation)

Generated on 2026-07-23.

1) Objective

$$g = g_{\text{delay}} + g_{\text{path}}$$

This is the co-design accumulated cost used by PPO transitions.

Source: `coarse_scheduler.py` (dynamic nodes), `evaluate.py` (final reporting).

2) What one Action means

At each decision node, PPO chooses one index over current legal branches.

One action corresponds to one branch and that branch carries the scheduling/path-decision effects.

Code references: `ppo_training/environment.py` (step/reset), `ppo_training/encoding.py` (encode_actions).

3) State / Action dimensions

$$d_{\text{state}} = 1 + N_r (d_s + 2(R+1) + 3R + 2P + M)$$

where N_r =number of robots, $R=n_{\text{resources}}$, $P=n_{\text{ports}}$, $M=\max_{\text{route}} \text{options}$, $d_s=\text{ROBOT_STATE_SCALARS}=10$.

$$d_{\text{action}} = N_r ((R+1) + 2(R+1) + d_a)$$

where $d_a=\text{ROBOT_ACTION_SCALARS}=4$.

Default EncodingConfig: $R=9$, $P=12$.

Source: `ppo_training/encoding.py` lines 47-67, 130-181.

4) Reward definition

At one environment step: $r_t = -(g_{t+1} - g_t) = -(\Delta g_t)$.

Code: `ppo_training/environment.py` lines 79-107.

5) PPOConfig defaults in trainer.py

$\gamma = 1.0$

$\lambda = 0.95$

$\epsilon = 0.2$

$c_1 = \text{entropy_coef} = 0.01$

$c_2 = \text{value_loss_coef} = 0.5$

$\text{lpha} = \text{learning_rate} = 3e{-4}$

$\text{update_epochs}=4$, $\text{minibatch_size}=64$, $\text{max_grad_norm}=0.5$,
 $\text{max_decisions_per_episode}=200$

$\text{reward_norm_mode}=\{\text{none}, \text{absmax}\}$, $\text{epsilon_norm}=1e{-12}$.

Source: `ppo_training/trainer.py` lines 25-39.

6) Command-line mapping in train.py

`--learning-rate` o\$ `PPOConfig.learning_rate`.

`--update-epochs` o\$ `PPOConfig.update_epochs`.

`--minibatch-size` o\$ `PPOConfig.minibatch_size`.

`--entropy-coef` o\$ `PPOConfig.entropy_coef`.

`--max-decisions` o\$ `PPOConfig.max_decisions_per_episode`.

`--reward-norm-mode/--lr-schedule/--entropy-schedule`\$ map to training behavior and schedules.

Also controls: `--skip-trivial-cases`, `--fix-shortest-paths`, `--bc-pretrain-episodes`.

Source: ppo_training/train.py 25-135, 337-375, 500-540.

7) GAE and targets

Temporal-difference: $\delta_t = r_t + \gamma V(s_{t+1}) - V(s_t)$.

Generalized Advantage: $\hat{A}_t = \delta_t + \gamma \lambda (\hat{A}_{t+1})$.

Value target: $V_t^{\text{target}} = \hat{A}_t + V(s_t)$.

Normalization: $\tilde{A}_t = (\hat{A}_t - \mu(\hat{A})) / (\sigma(\hat{A}) + 1e{-8})$.

Source: ppo_training/rollout_buffer.py 47-63.

8) PPO update formulas

Density ratio: $ho_t = \exp(\log \pi_{\theta}(a_t|s_t) - \log \pi_{\theta_{old}}(a_t|s_t))$.

$L_t^{\text{surrogate}} = \min(ho_t \hat{A}_t, \text{clip}(ho_t, 1-\epsilon, 1+\epsilon) \hat{A}_t)$.

$L^{\text{actor}} = -\mathbb{E}[L_t^{\text{surrogate}}]$.

$J^{\text{actor}} = L^{\text{actor}} - c_1 H(\pi \cdot |s_t)$.

$L^{\text{critic}} = \mathbb{E}[(V_{\phi}(s_t) - V_t^{\text{target}})^2]$.

$J^{\text{critic}} = c_2 L^{\text{critic}}$.

Also logged: $\text{approx_kl} = \mathbb{E}[(ho_t - 1) - \log ho_t]$,

$\text{clip_fraction} = \mathbb{E}[ho_t - 1 | > \epsilon]$.

Source: ppo_training/trainer.py 329-360.

9) Networks

Actor: BranchScoringActor

Input is one state concatenated with each branch action vector. Shared MLP, output one logit per branch.

Critic: StateValueCritic

Input is state, output scalar $V(s)$.

Defaults: 2 hidden layers, hidden_dim=128.

Source: ppo_training/networks.py 15-97.

10) Training loop

Data flow: collect_rollouts → collect_episode → RolloutBuffer → update_with_entropy.

Within one episode: state/action encode → actor sample/greedy → env step → reward/GAE storage.

Per update: shuffle all rollout steps, run update_epochs passes, minibatch updates for actor + critic.

Source: ppo_training/trainer.py 229-375.

11) Evaluation and gaps

Greedy inference gives $J_{\text{PPO}} = \text{ppo_cost}$; exact gives $J^* = \text{exact_cost}$.

Absolute gap: $\Delta_{\text{abs}} = J_{\text{PPO}} - J^*$.

Relative gap: $\Delta_{\text{rel}} = \frac{\Delta_{\text{abs}}}{|J^*|}$.

If $J^* = 0$, define $\Delta_{\text{rel}} = 0$ if $J_{\text{PPO}} = 0$, else $\Delta_{\text{rel}} = \infty$.

Source: ppo_training/evaluate.py 109-114.

12) Exact expansion/pruning note

Environment uses immediate branch expansion without branch-and-bound pruning during rollout actions.

Exact solver pruning remains in search functions and is not part of PPO action logits directly.
Source: `coarse_scheduler.py` 1241-1253, 1256-1262, 1293/1319.

If you want a full LaTeX-only reference with theorem-style formatting, I can convert this to a separate file (e.g., `.tex` or `.md`) in the next step.